

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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Finding Reasoning Paths :

1. **Anhedonia**: Persistent inability to feel pleasure in activities previously enjoyed .
2. **Depressed Mood**: Chronic sadness and hopelessness , worse over the past 2 weeks .
3. **Sleep Impairment**: Not explicitly stated in this case but often associated with depression .
4. **Insomnia**: Difficulty falling or staying asleep , which may contribute to chronic fatigue .
5. **Inability to make decisions**: Poor ability to make decisions could be a sign of depression or fatigue .
6. **Low Energy**: Fatigue and low energy are classic symptoms of depression .
7. **Self-esteem disturbances**: Feelings of guilt and inability to appreciate achievements can be linked to depression .
8. **Suicidal ideation**: Feelings of suicidal thoughts indicate significant emotional distress , often associated with depression .
9. **History of depression**: The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember , suggesting a chronic or recurring condition .

Reasoning Process :

1. **Anhedonia**: The patient reports a pervasive sense of sadness and hopelessness , which could suggest anhedonia . Anhedonia is a key feature of major depressive disorder , where individuals find little joy in activities they once enjoyed .
2. **Depressed Mood**: The patient’s chronic sadness and hopelessness , along with the worsening suicidal ideation and self-esteem disturbances over the past 2 weeks , strongly suggest a depressive episode . These symptoms align with major depressive disorder .
3. **Sleep Impairment**: While insomnia is mentioned in the question , it is not explicitly stated here . However , chronic fatigue and inability to concentrate are consistent with sleep disturbances , which are common in depression .
4. **Inability to make decisions**: The poor ability to make decisions could be due to severe fatigue , cognitive impairment , or decreased motivation , all of which are common in major depressive disorder .
5. **Low Energy**: The chronic fatigue and difficulty concentrating are classic symptoms of depression . Fatigue in depression is often due to reduced activity , decreased physical exertion , or psychological weariness .
6. **Self-esteem disturbances**: The patient feels guilty and lacks the ability to appreciate his achievements , which are hallmark symptoms of depression . These feelings of worthlessness and inadequacy are common in major depressive disorder .
7. **Suicidal Ideation**: The significant increase in suicidal ideation over the past 2 weeks is a critical concern . Suicidal thoughts are a serious warning sign of a severe depressive episode and require urgent attention .
8. **History of depression**: The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember , which suggests a history of depression . This chronicity is consistent with major depressive disorder , which often presents as a persistent , recurrent condition .

Conclusion :

The patient’s condition best aligns with **major depressive disorder (MDD)** . This conclusion is supported by the chronicity of symptoms , depressed mood , anhedonia , self-esteem disturbances , low energy , impaired concentration , and suicidal ideation . The decision-making impairment and fatigue are likely secondary to the depressed state and could resolve with appropriate treatment .

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<answer>

The patient is likely to show anhedonia .

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